



MEFETAB FILM-COATED TABLET 500mg

Description: Yellow, oval, biconvex with 'P-P' embossed film-coated tablet.

Content:

Mefenamic Acid 500mg/tablet

Indication:

For short term relief of mild to moderate pain such as dental pain, headache, postoperative and postpartum pain, dysmenorrhoea, rheumatic disorder such as osteoarthritis, rheumatic arthritis and menorrhagia.

Pharmacology:

Mefenamic acid has analgesic, anti-inflammatory and antipyretic actions. By inhibiting the synthesis and activity of intrauterine prostaglandins, it decreases uterine contractility and relieves spasmodic pain in dysmenorrhoea. It is well absorbed orally and extensively bound to plasma proteins. It undergoes hepatic metabolism and renal excretion.

Adverse effects:

Gastrointestinal disturbances, peptic ulceration and GIT bleeding, headache, drowsiness, dizziness, nausea or vomiting, visual disturbances, skin rash or pruritis (hypersensitive reactions), nervousness, diarrhoea, tinnitus, oedema, depression, insomnia and impairment of renal function may occur in some patients.

Precautions:

- Caution in patients with renal or liver function impairment, epilepsy and hypoprothrombinemia.
- Therapy should be discontinued if diarrhoea or skin rash occurs.
- Take with meals. Avoid alcoholic beverages.

Cardiovascular Thrombotic Events

Observational studies have indicated that non-selective NSAIDs may be associated with an increased risk of serious cardiovascular events, principally myocardial infarction, which may increase with dose or duration of use. Patients with cardiovascular disease or cardiovascular risk of an adverse cardiovascular event in patient taking NSAID, especially in those with cardiovascular risk factors, the lowest effective dose should be used for the shortest possible duration.

There is no consistent evidence that the concurrent use of aspirin mitigates the possible increased risk of serious cardiovascular thrombotic events associated with NSAID use.

Hypertension

NSAIDs may lead to the onset of new hypertension or worsening the pre-existing hypertension and patients taking antihypertensive with NSAIDs may have an impaired anti-hypertensive response. Caution is advised when prescribing NSAIDs to patients with hypertension. Blood pressure should be monitored closely during initiation of NSAID treatment and at regular intervals thereafter.

Heart Failure

Fluid retention and oedema have been observed in some patients taking NSAIDs, there caution is advised in patients with fluid retention or heart failure.

Gastrointestinal Events

All NSAIDs can cause gastrointestinal discomfort and rarely serious, potentially fatal gastrointestinal effects such as ulcers, bleeding and perforation which may increase with dose or duration of use, but can occur at any time without warning. Caution is advised in patients with risk factors for gastrointestinal events e.g. the elderly, those with a history of serious gastrointestinal events, smoking and alcoholism. When gastrointestinal bleeding or ulcerations occur in patients receiving NSAIDs, the drug should be withdrawn immediately. Doctors should warn



patient about signs and symptoms of serious gastrointestinal toxicity. The concurrent use of aspirin and NSAIDs also increases the risk of serious gastrointestinal adverse events.

Severe Skin Reactions

NSAIDs may very rarely cause serious cutaneous adverse events such as exfoliative dermatitis, toxic epidermal necrolysis (TEN) and Stevens-Johnson Syndrome (SJS), which can be fatal and occur without warning. These serious adverse events are idiosyncratic and are independent of dose or duration of use. Patients should be advised of the signs and symptoms of serious skin reactions and to consult their doctor at the first appearance of a skin rash or any other sign of hypersensitivity.

Contraindications:

- Avoid in patients with peptic ulceration or inflammatory bowel disease.
- Not recommended for children under 14 year of age, women during pregnancy and lactation, and patients known to be hypersensitive to the drug.

Drug Interactions

Mefenamic acid may enhance the effects of the coumarin anticoagulants.

Dosage and Administration

Adults and children over 14 year - oral, 500mg initially, followed by 250mg every 6 hours as needed.

Dysmenorrhoea - Oral, 500mg three times a day.

Medication should be initiated with the onset of bleeding and associated symptoms and should not be necessary for more than 2 to 3 days.

Note: It is recommended that mefenamic acid should not be used for more than 7 days at a time.

After assessing the risk/benefit ratio in each individual patient, the lowest effective dose for the shortest possible duration should be used.

Overdosage

Convulsions have been reported. Treatment consists of emesis or gastric lavage, administering activated charcoal, or the necessary symptomatic and supportive measures.

WARNINGS

RISK OF GI ULCERATION, BLEEDING AND PERFORATION WITH NSAID

Serious GI toxicity such as bleeding, ulceration and perforation can occur at any time, with or without warning symptoms. In patients treated with NSAID therapy. Although minor upper GI problems (e.g. dyspepsia) are common, usually developing early in therapy, prescribers should remain alert for ulceration and bleeding in patients treated with NSAIDs even in absence of previous GI tract symptoms.

Studies to date have not identified an subset of patients not at risk of developing peptic ulceration and bleeding. Patients with prior history of serious adverse events and other risk factors associated with peptic ulcer disease (e.g. alcoholism, smoking, and corticosteroid therapy) are at increased risk. Elderly or debilitated patients seem to tolerate ulceration or bleeding less than other individuals and account for most spontaneous reports for fatal GI events.

Storage	: Keep container tightly closed. Store in a cool, dry place below 30°C. Protect from light. Keep away from children.
Presentation / Packing	: Film-coated tablet 500mg x 1000's
Shelflife	: 3 years
Manufactured & Distributed by	: PRIME PHARMACEUTICAL SDN. BHD. 1505, Lrg Perusahaan Utama 1, Taman Perindustrian Bukit Tengah, 14000 Bukit Mertajam, Penang Malaysia.